



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Ascension Classical School

School Website: <https://www.ascensionclassicalschool.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Ascension Classical School (Shreveport, LA, 71105) presents a robust classical Christian program and public-facing materials that align strongly with the Six Essential Elements of Classical Education. Across all six rubric categories, the school demonstrates Trivium-based pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric), a Great-Books-oriented curriculum, liturgical and communal religious practices, explicit formation of character, a faculty culture positioned as mentors within a living curriculum, and a proactive, parent-inclusive community ethos. Core statements emphasize Christ-centered, biblical education, the Great Conversation through Great Books, a emphasis on memory and wonder in lower grades, and Socratic/seminar-style inquiry in upper levels. These features map well to the knowledge-criteria in the classical rubric and place ASC in the CLASSICAL category across all six dimensions. Notable textual anchors include: the mission to glorify God through Christ-centered education and biblical/classical curriculum (and a campus culture of devotion and formation) ; explicit reference to the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and the Great Conversation through Great Books (including chants, songs, and memory-based methods in Grammar) ; a Rhetoric-stage emphasis on persuasive communication and integrated study in upper grades ; a stated parental/community emphasis and testimonials from families that frame parents as partners and co-educators ; and documented evidence of Great-Books-centric reading programs and a portrait of a graduate oriented toward Trivium-based formation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence: Mission statements center on glorifying God and Christ-centered education; biblical/classical curriculum is highlighted; references to liturgical practices appear in public materials (e.g., chapel, devotionals, and prayerful orientation) alongside classical pedagogy. For example, the mission explicitly states a Christ-centered, biblical program, and the site highlights devotion-driven language and God-centered learning ; lower grades emphasize singing/chanting and a memory-friendly approach rooted in religious formation. The site also foregrounds communal worship/chapel and related spiritual formation practices in public-facing materials. Great-Books and Great-Conversation references further anchor the metaphysical ideal of truth through canonical works and moral formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include: God, Christ-centered, biblical, devotion, worship (liturgical orientation), Great Books, Great Conversation, formation, virtue, character, wisdom, truth, beauty, and love of learning (all drawn from the school's public materials and aligned with the Positive Keyword indicators). Negative keywords (e.g., secular ethics, value-neutral, relativism) are not evidenced in the public materials; the materials strongly reject secular-neutral formulations in favor of theology-informed formation. Quantitatively, visible positive indicators vastly outnumber explicit negative indicators in this category.

Why this rating: The school's public communications align with transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty) in a theologically grounded framework, with liturgical and communal practices (chapel/devotionals) and a clear theology-centered formation aim. This satisfies the core elements of Religious and Metaphysical Foundations in the classical rubric.

- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence: The mission emphasizes formation and virtue (formation over mere information; character formation and virtuous disposition as goals), with explicit language about forming “servant leaders who love God” and a “biblical, classical, and comprehensive curriculum” that aims at wisdom and virtue over vocational training alone. The Portrait of a Graduate explicitly frames education as forming a Trivium-based citizen through a Culmination of three components (course, community, culture) and emphasizes formation of godly character alongside curriculum. Public narratives show families valuing the formation of thinking and virtue over mere test performance.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords observed include formation, virtue, character, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, love of learning, Logos, sacred tradition, and moral education. There is little or no use of negative-keyword signals (e.g., “career readiness” detached from formation, or “skills over character”). The material strongly emphasizes formation (formation, virtue, character, wisdom) and the transcendentals (truth, beauty, goodness), aligning with Positive Keywords in the Six Elements document.

Why this rating: The school's stated objective foregrounds formation and virtue rather than vocational preparation, consistent with the classical model's aim for human excellence and the great-tradition formation described in the rubric.

- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence: The curriculum centers on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and, in the Grammar School, emphasizes a building-block approach through memorization, chants, songs, drama, poetry, and a broad Great-Books orientation that invites “Great Conversation” through familiarity with canonical works. The Rhetoric School section describes a focus on understanding the why of disciplines, with emphasis on rhetoric, essays, and integrated study—i.e., a coherence across subjects rather than isolated “social studies” content. Reading programs include Great Books literacy and columns reading society content that reinforces cross-disciplinary integration, as shown in material about Anchor Books and literature societies. The site explicitly anchors curriculum in classical education through “grammar, logic, rhetoric” and a “Great Conversation” framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords observed include Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, integration of history with literature, and formation through the arts. Negative keywords associated with anti-classical trends (e.g., “skills-based,” “workforce readiness” detached from the liberal-arts formation) are not present in the school's public materials. The presence of Great Books, Trivium, and integrated history/literature/science aligns with the Positive Keywords in the knowledge document.

Why this rating: The explicit Trivium framework, Great-Books/Great Conversation emphasis, and integrated, cross-disciplinary approach map directly to Element 3's classical curriculum criteria.

- Element 4: Pedagogy/Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence: Lower-school pedagogy emphasizes contemplative, ceremonial, and memory-rich methods (singing, chants, memorization) as well as a slower, more contemplative pace; upper-school pedagogy uses Socratic-like discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric instruction; public materials also highlight integrated, cross-disciplinary instruction and presentations (e.g., emphasis on rhetoric and public speaking in the Rhetoric School). The “Portrait of a Graduate” and “Grammar School” content describe memory-based and wonder-filled teaching in early grades, followed by Socratic and rhetoric-based experiences in higher grades, consistent with classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords observed include memorization, chants, songs, drama, poetry, questions-led inquiry, Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, rhetoric, and speeches. The

site presents a graded shift from contemplative/memory-based lower-division pedagogy to Socratic and rhetoric-based upper-division pedagogy. Negative keywords (if present) would be terms indicating excessively rote, non-discursive, or anti-Socratic approaches; none are evident in the public materials. The distribution of lower-grade chant/memory methods and upper-grade dialogue/rhetoric aligns strongly with the classical pedagogy indicators.

Why this rating: The school articulates a clear progression from memory-driven, contemplative lower grades to Socratic/seminar and rhetoric-focused upper grades, matching the classical pedagogy model.

- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence: The site emphasizes “the teachers” as instrumental actors in the formation process; testimonials describe teachers as part of a loving, Christian learning environment; statements repeatedly frame the faculty as central to the living curriculum and the school’s classical approach; the school’s materials describe the faculty as modeling virtue and being the core of the school’s culture; a public quote notes teaching as “time-tested classical education model” and that the school seeks mentors who embody the virtues described in the classical tradition. The materials also reference continued professional environment for teachers and a community of families that collaborate with teachers to form character and intellect.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, core of the school, portrait of a teacher, and collaborative teacher-student relationships. Negative keywords (e.g., “teacher autonomy over students” or “disciplinary failures”) are not present. The public materials portray a pedagogy-grounded faculty culture consistent with the classical rubric.

Why this rating: The faculty is presented as virtuous, formative, and central to the curriculum (the living curriculum), aligning with the classical teacher-mentors ideal.

- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence: The school explicitly positions parents as partners and co-educators; testimonials emphasize a strong parent community and the involvement of families in school life; admissions materials encourage parent reading and engagement, and there are explicit references to parent involvement in governance and support structures; there are also notes about parent participation in open houses and in the school’s mission to partner with families. The public materials invite visits and engagement with families, a hallmark of classical education’s emphasis on home-school partnership as part of a shared mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, co-educators, parental engagement, home-school collaboration, family formation, and living tradition in the family. Negative keywords are not evident; the site does not present a detached or independent-parent model but rather a collaborative partnership with families. The presence of parent-facing materials and events supports the “Partners with Parents” criterion.

Why this rating: The school consistently frames parents as co-educators and welcomes family involvement, with active family testimonials and invitations for campus visits, aligning with the classical Parents & Community criteria.

Aggregate Assessment

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Rationale: Across all six categories, Ascension Classical School Le 71105 demonstrates the core features of classical education: a Trivium-based curriculum with Great Books and the Great Conversation; a formation-centric purpose anchored in virtue and truth; a pedagogy that blends contemplative lower-division methods with Socratic/seminar and rhetoric-driven instruction in the upper grades; a faculty described as mentors within a living curriculum; and strong parent/community partnership. The textual anchors cited above support these conclusions, including explicit mission statements, Trivium and Great Books references, and the presence of liturgical/community practices in the public-facing materials. See citations for the specific textual anchors: Great Conversation and Great Books (turn0file1); Trivium and grammar/logic/rhetoric (turn0file2); Rhetoric pedagogy (turn0file3); Christ-centered mission (turn0file4); formation-focused language (turn0file6); Great Books/Reading programs (turn0file7,

turn0file10); parental partnership language (turn0file0, turn0file4); and the Foundation/Portrait language (turn0file18).

- What would move the needle (only applicable if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL): Not applicable here, as the school is classified CLASSICAL. No major needle-moving changes are required to achieve CLASSICAL status. If desired for continuous improvement, potential micro-initiatives could include explicitly mapping every category's positive keyword occurrences to a public-facing, category-level rubric matrix to further demonstrate compliance, and adding explicit statements in public materials about practices like liturgy, contemplation (scholé), and historical formation to enhance visibility of the Religious & Metaphysical Foundations category.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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